



Trading Copier Setup and Use Guide

Agent version 0.9.0
Windows, Mac Apple Silicon, and Mac Intel

Revised 13 August 2026

Read this first

The Trading Copier receives encrypted trade signals from Andre and prepares the corresponding order in your own Schwab account. By default, every entry waits for you to approve it. Exits are handled automatically so an open copied position is not abandoned.

You run the program on your own computer. Andre never receives your Schwab password, app secret, balance, positions, or private encryption key.

Trading can lose money. Options can lose their entire value quickly. The copier is a tool, not investment advice, account management, or a promise of results.

Three operational facts

- Your computer must remain awake and connected while you hold copied positions.
- Schwab requires each person to reconnect about every seven days.
- Use Approve first and practice mode until you understand every screen.

Official resources

Installation page	https://dre15w1.github.io/trading-copier-install/
Checksums	https://github.com/dre15w1/trading-copier-install/releases/latest/download/SHA256SUMS.txt

The complete setup in one page

- 1** Create your personal Schwab developer app and wait until Schwab marks it **Ready for Use**.
- 2** Open the official installation page, read the disclosures, sign the agreement, and choose the download for your computer.
- 3** Run the copier. It opens a local setup page at **http://127.0.0.1:8765**.
- 4** Enter your name. The app creates your key locally and displays a **TV1- device code**.
- 5** Click **Copy device code** and send the complete TV1- code to Andre. Never send your Schwab secret or private key.
- 6** Andre opens Signal Access, pastes your code, confirms the fingerprint, and grants specific strategies.
- 7** Confirm Andre's publisher fingerprint by phone, connect Schwab, choose limits, and leave **Approve first** selected.
- 8** Receive a synthetic test entry and exit before considering live execution.
- 9** Enable start at login and prevent the computer from sleeping during market hours.

The TV1- code is safe to send. It contains a device identifier and public key only. The private key stays in Windows Credential Manager, macOS Keychain, or the app's protected local fallback.

Create your Schwab developer app

Go to <https://developer.schwab.com>, create an Individual developer account, and create an app for your own brokerage account. Approval often takes several business days.

Use these values

Field	Value
API product	Accounts and Trading Production; add Market Data Production if offered
App name	Any simple personal name, such as Jane Copier
Callback URL	https://127.0.0.1:8182/callback
Description	Personal trading automation for my own self-directed account

The callback must match exactly. A trailing slash, localhost in place of 127.0.0.1, or a different scheme can break authorization. Changing it after approval may send the app back through review.

When the app becomes Ready for Use, copy its App Key/Client ID and Secret/Client Secret into the copier setup screen. Do not send either value to Andre.

Download the correct app

Use the official installation page. The three downloads are separate because Windows and the two Mac CPU families require different native executables.

Windows 10 or 11 - 64-bit

```
https://github.com/dre15w1/trading-copier-install/releases/latest/download/copier-agent-windows.exe
```

Mac with Apple Silicon - M1, M2, M3, M4, or newer

```
https://github.com/dre15w1/trading-copier-install/releases/latest/download/copier-agent-macos-apple-silicon
```

Mac with an Intel processor

```
https://github.com/dre15w1/trading-copier-install/releases/latest/download/copier-agent-macos-intel
```

On a Mac, choose Apple menu > About This Mac. If it says Chip and begins with Apple M, choose Apple Silicon. If it says Processor and mentions Intel, choose Intel.

Only download from the official page. These builds are currently unsigned, so your operating system will warn you. A copy sent through email, text, AirDrop, or an unfamiliar link should not be run.

Run it on Windows

- 1 Open your Downloads folder.
- 2 Double-click **copier-agent-windows.exe**.
- 3 If Windows SmartScreen appears, verify the filename, select **More info**, then **Run anyway**.
- 4 Your browser opens **http://127.0.0.1:8765**. That address means the page is served only by your own computer.

Practice mode

Open PowerShell and run:

```
& "$env:USERPROFILE\Downloads\copier-agent-windows.exe" --dry-run
```

Practice mode receives signals and exercises the workflow but sends no real order to Schwab. Confirm the practice banner is visible.

Run it on a Mac

Download the correct Mac build first. Open Terminal, paste the full block below, and press Return. It selects the filename that matches your Mac CPU.

```
if [ "$(uname -m)" = "arm64" ]; then
FILE="$HOME/Downloads/copier-agent-macos-apple-silicon"
else
FILE="$HOME/Downloads/copier-agent-macos-intel"
fi
chmod +x "$FILE"
xattr -d com.apple.quarantine "$FILE"
"$FILE"
```

For practice mode, use the same selection block but make the last line:

```
"$FILE" --dry-run
```

If Terminal says No such file or directory, confirm the file is in Downloads and that its name has no (1) suffix. If it says Bad CPU type in executable, you downloaded the wrong Mac architecture; delete it and choose the other Mac button.

Setup wizard - steps 1 and 2

Step 1 - Welcome

Read the summary, confirm you understand that this is your account and risk, then continue.

Step 2 - About you and your device code

- 1 Enter your name and optional contact details.
- 2 Use the subscriber/device identifier Andre supplied, or allow the app to create one.
- 3 Click **Save and make my key**.
- 4 Click **Copy device code**. The complete value begins with **TV1-**.
- 5 Send the complete TV1- code to Andre. Keep the app open while he adds you.

Do not send screenshots of Schwab credentials. Do not send files from the .trading-copier folder. Andre needs only the TV1- device code for signal access.

If you replace your computer, the new installation gets a new code. Send the new TV1- code to Andre so he can replace the old device. The old computer then stops receiving future entries.

Setup wizard - steps 3 through 6

Step 3 - Confirm Andre

- Use the public signal-bus address supplied in the app or by Andre.
- Confirm Andre's publisher fingerprint by voice or a phone number you dialed.
- Do not accept a changed fingerprint merely because a message tells you to.

Step 4 - Connect Schwab

- Paste your App Key and Secret from your approved Schwab developer app.
- Keep the callback URL identical to the registered value.
- Click Connect Schwab, sign in on Schwab's website, and approve.
- If the browser does not return automatically, copy the entire callback address and use the setup page's paste box.

Step 5 - Choose limits

- Start with a small risk percentage and low maximum position count.
- Leave Approve first selected. Automatic execution requires a separate acknowledgement.
- Keep publisher exits enabled so an accepted trade can be closed when Andre closes it.

Step 6 - Finish

- Confirm the publisher fingerprint is verified.
- Confirm Schwab is connected to the intended account.
- Enable start at login and keep the computer awake.

What Andre does in Signal Access

On Andre's computer, Signal Access runs locally at `http://127.0.0.1:8788`. It is not a public website.

- 1** Click **Add someone**.
- 2** Paste the friend's complete TV1- device code.
- 3** Confirm the device fingerprint with the friend.
- 4** Select the strategies that person may receive.
- 5** Record the signed agreement if required, then save.
- 6** Send a synthetic entry and exit before any live use.

Revocation

Removing a strategy or disabling a subscriber stops new entries from being encrypted to that device. A subscriber who already entered a position continues receiving the corresponding exit, preventing revocation from stranding an open trade.

The private key never reaches Andre. Signal Access imports only the public device code and cannot generate the friend's private half.

Test before live trading

- 1** Keep the subscriber app in practice mode and Approve first mode.
- 2** Andre publishes a synthetic test entry for one granted strategy.
- 3** Confirm the test signal appears and is clearly labeled synthetic.
- 4** Approve it and confirm no real Schwab order is sent in practice mode.
- 5** Confirm the matching synthetic exit arrives.
- 6** Restart the app and confirm it opens normally and still shows the same TV1- device code in Settings.

Do not switch to live execution if the test entry or exit is missing, the publisher fingerprint is unconfirmed, Schwab shows the wrong account, or the app reports an uncertain order.

After practice

Watch the system for several sessions. When you intentionally leave practice mode, keep Approve first enabled and start with the smallest sensible risk.

Using the copier day to day

- Leave the agent running and the computer awake whenever a copied position is open.
- Review symbol, direction, contract, quantity, maximum cost, stop, and strategy before approving.
- Decline anything you do not understand. Missing a trade is safer than approving blindly.
- If an order is marked uncertain, check Schwab before trying anything again. Never assume it failed.
- Use the copier's Positions page or Schwab directly to close a position when necessary.
- Reconnect Schwab before the seven-day authorization expires.

Weekly reconnect

- 1 Choose a consistent evening each week, such as Sunday.
- 2 Click Reconnect Schwab in the copier.
- 3 Sign in on Schwab's website and approve.
- 4 If needed, paste the full callback URL into the copier's recovery box.
- 5 Confirm the dashboard shows roughly seven days remaining.

Long Term and shared-account partitions

The native Long Term screen is optional. It can research tickers, scan a watchlist, show holdings, prepare trim or exit proposals, find covered-call candidates, and submit an approved proposal through your own connected Schwab account.

Partition before buying

- 1 Open **Long Term** from the navigation.
- 2 Set the percentage of account equity reserved for Long Term. It starts at **0%**, so it cannot open a position until you choose an amount.
- 3 The copied/short-term side sizes from the remaining percentage. For example, 25% Long Term leaves 75% for short-term sizing.
- 4 Review the committed amount on the screen before creating another opening proposal.

Both sides also recheck live broker buying power. A partition is a software limit, not a separate Schwab subaccount; Schwab still reports one combined balance.

Approval is the default

- Research does not place an order.
- Buy, add, trim, exit, and covered-call actions enter the approval queue.
- Immediately before submission the app rechecks the partition, buying power, owned shares, covered shares, and live bid/ask spread.
- An uncertain broker response is never retried automatically; inspect Schwab first.
- Automatic Long Term execution is a separate override with its own acknowledgement. Ordinary copier automation does not enable it.

Optional AI - choose one of three providers

Long Term works in **No AI** mode. If you choose a provider, it is your provider account, key, usage, and bill. Andre's LLM credentials are not present in the subscriber app and cannot be borrowed as a fallback.

OpenAI

- 1 Open <https://platform.openai.com/docs/quickstart/make-your-first-api-request> and create your own API account and API key.
- 2 Add API billing or credits. A ChatGPT subscription does not include API usage.
- 3 Review the current provider prices at <https://openai.com/api/pricing/> and use the provider dashboard to set a spending limit if available.
- 4 In Long Term, choose OpenAI, enter a supported model name and paste the key, acknowledge direct billing, save, and click **Test connection**.
- 5 Run one ticker before a watchlist scan. Use **Delete saved key** to remove it from this computer.

Anthropic

- 1 Open <https://console.anthropic.com/>, create your own account, enable API billing, and create an API key.
- 2 Review current prices and model names at <https://docs.anthropic.com/en/docs/about-claude/pricing>.
- 3 In Long Term, choose Anthropic, enter a supported model name and paste the key, acknowledge direct billing, save, and test.
- 4 Run one ticker first. Delete the saved key from the screen when changing providers or retiring the computer.

Provider prices and model availability change. The links above are authoritative. Deep scans can make one paid call per ticker; the app does not promise a fixed dollar cost.

Optional local AI with Ollama

Ollama has no per-call provider bill, but model downloads can use tens of gigabytes and analysis uses memory, CPU or GPU time, electricity, and your hardware. Intel Macs use CPU-only execution and may be slow.

- 1** Install Ollama from <https://ollama.com/download>. The current Ollama requirements may be newer than the copier's own operating-system requirements, so check that page first.
- 2** Open PowerShell on Windows or Terminal on Mac and run **ollama run llama3.2**. Wait for the model download and one successful response.
- 3** Keep Ollama running. In the copier's Long Term screen choose **Ollama (local)**.
- 4** Keep the local URL **http://127.0.0.1:11434**, enter **llama3.2** as the model, save, and test.
- 5** Run one-ticker research before scanning a watchlist.

The copier accepts only a loopback Ollama address in this release. It will reject a remote hostname so portfolio facts are not silently sent to an unreviewed server.

If the test fails

- Start the Ollama application and try again.
- If the model is missing, run **ollama run llama3.2** and let it finish downloading.
- If the computer runs out of memory or becomes too slow, choose No AI or a smaller local model.
- OpenAI/Anthropic 401 or 403 errors usually mean the key or billing is not ready; 429 means a provider usage or rate limit. Check the provider dashboard.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
Windows protected your PC	Verify the official filename and source, then More info > Run anyway.
Mac says damaged or cannot verify	Run chmod and xattr commands from section 6 against the correct architecture file.
Bad CPU type	Delete the file and download the other Mac architecture.
No such file or directory	Check Downloads and remove any (1) suffix by downloading once cleanly.
No signals	Keep the app running; confirm Andre added the current TV1- code and granted that strategy.
Fingerprint changed	Stop. Confirm with Andre by phone before accepting any change.
Schwab connection expired	Reconnect immediately. No entry or exit can be submitted until authorization is restored.
Uncertain order	Open Schwab and inspect orders and positions. Do not resubmit automatically.

If you are confused while holding a real position, the safe move is to check Schwab, close the position if appropriate, and call Andre. Your Schwab account remains the final source of truth.

Security and storage

Local folder

```
Windows: C:\Users\<you>\.trading-copier\  
macOS: ~/.trading-copier/
```

- agent.json contains settings and is designed not to contain secrets.
- state.db contains local positions, approvals, and history.
- agent.log records operational events for troubleshooting.
- Secrets are stored in Windows Credential Manager or macOS Keychain when available.

Never share

- Schwab username, password, App Secret, or refresh authorization.
- The copier private encryption key or secrets.json fallback.
- Remote-control access to the computer while Schwab is open.

Safe to share with Andre

- The complete TV1- device code shown by the copier.
- The publisher/device fingerprint read aloud for confirmation.
- A redacted screenshot of a non-secret error page or the app log when requested.

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